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Chapter 9

Currency Conversion And Download



What Is Currency Conversion?

This is an Explorer Toolbar option which can be enabled using the System Configuration utility. With this toolbar button pressed, you can use the Ctrl+F1 key combination, in System 21 applications, to display a tooltip with the conversion results for the Application window field under the mouse pointer.



Note: When you request a Currency Conversion, the Currency Calculator window is displayed. Use the Currency Calculator to perform ad hoc calculations and change conversion settings.

The Currency Conversion function retrieves its currency information from an access database, JBAEMU.MDB, which is on your PC. You can specify the location of this file using the System Configuration utility. This database contains a copy of the relevant System 21 financial files required to perform currency conversion.



Note: The Currency Download must be run before you use the Currency Conversion option. The Currency Download copies the relevant System 21 financial files to the local access database.

What Is Currency Download?



Warning: Currency Download is intended for the System Administrator only.

This is the utility you use to refresh the database, JBAEMU.MDB, on your PC. This is installed onto your PC as part of the Administration Tools and appears as a separate item on your Program List.

The utility uses ODBC to communicate with the server. Please refer to the documentation supplied with the communications package, for example Client Access, which you use to communicate with your AS/400 server.

When downloading, the ODBC data source you select must specify the currency server files location. For example, if using an AS/400 as the System 21 server then the data source used to download the currency data should have the library which contains the currency files FLP081 and FLP083 in its list of default libraries.



Note: You need to run the Currency Download each time you update the currency files in System 21.

Tutorial

This tutorial is in two stages:



Warning: Stage 1 of the tutorial is for the System Administrator.

- Stage 1 Currency Download: This shows you how to download the currency data to the local database.
- Stage 2 Currency Conversion. This stage shows you how to set up and use the currency conversion option. This stage of the tutorial is for the Explorer user.

Stage 1 Currency Download



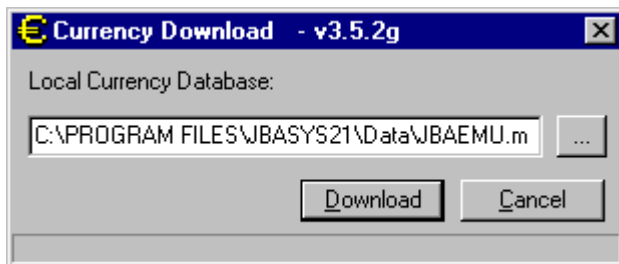
Warning: This stage of the tutorial is intended for the System Administrator. If you just want to use Currency Conversion, go straight to Stage 2.



Note: You should run this currency download whenever you make any changes to the currency files on System 21.

Step 1 Selecting The Local Database

To open the currency download, click on Currency Download in your program list.



Enter the name of the local database file you want to update.

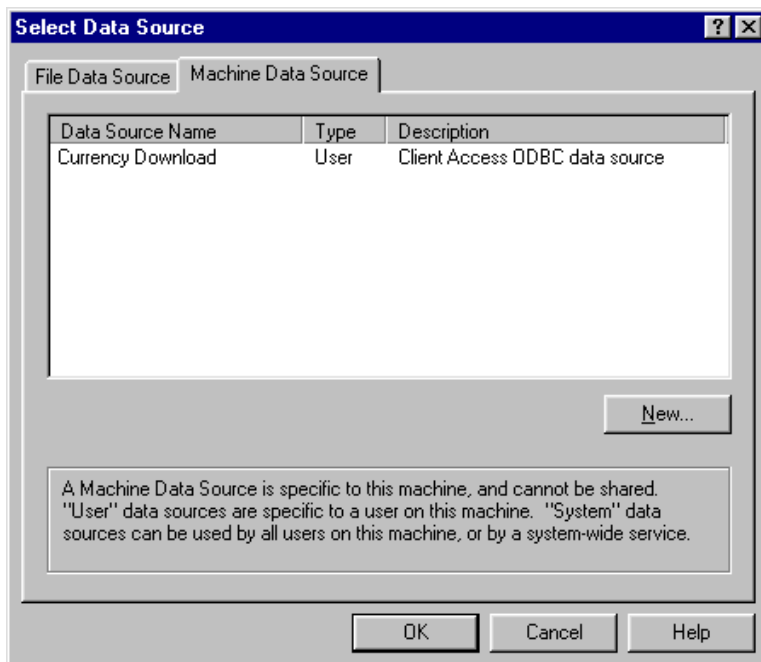


Note: This must be the same as the Currency Database Location field on the System Configuration Settings panel.

Then click the Download button.

Step 2 Selecting The Source Data

On the Select Data Source Window, select the Machine Data Source panel.



Select the Currency Download data source.



Note: You access this data source using ODBC, please refer to the documentation supplied with the communications package, for example Client Access, which you use to communicate with your AS/400 server.



Tip: If you need to set up this data source, refer to Step 3 Setting Up A Data Source for brief instructions, otherwise go to Step 4 Running the Download.

Step 3 Setting Up A Data Source

To set up a new data source, on the Machine Data Source Window, click on the New button. This displays a wizard which takes you step by step through the procedure.

Choose the type of data source required, this is normally User, then click the next button.

Choose the driver. This should be the Client Access ODBC Driver for AS/400 Servers.

Click the Next button, check the details are correct, then click the Finish button.

Enter Currency Download as the name of the new data source and select the System with the currency information on. If required, enter the User ID. Click on the Server tab and specify the libraries and then click on the Other tab and make sure the Translation option is checked.

Then click the OK button. The new data source is added to the list.

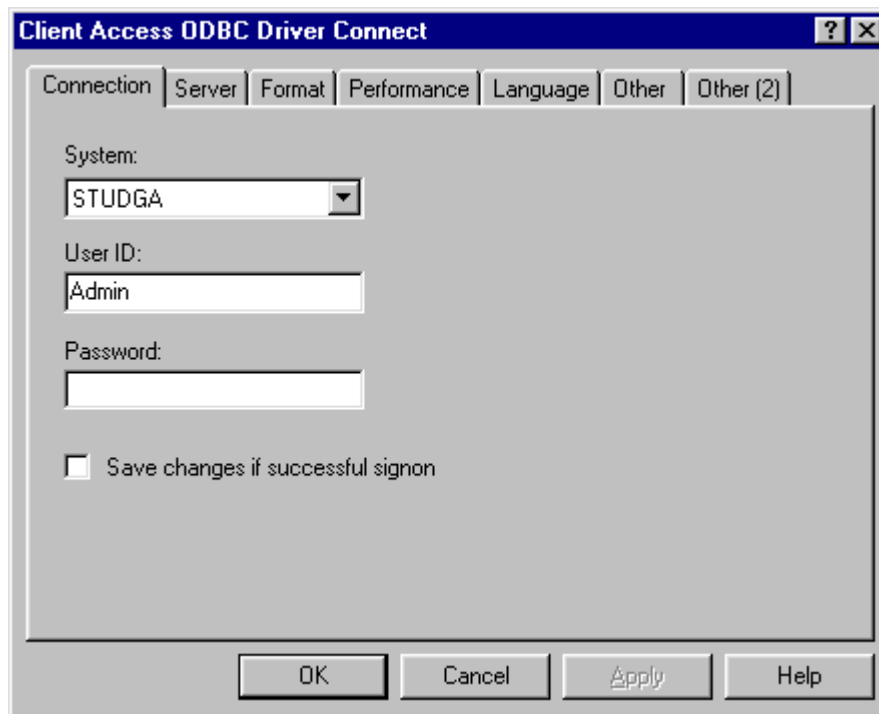
For more detailed information on setting up the Machine Data Source, refer to the ODBC Windows Help.

Step 4 Running The Download

Enter your User ID and Password for the selected data source. Then click the OK button.

The screenshot shows a Windows-style dialog box titled "Signon to AS/400". It has a standard title bar with a question mark icon and a close button (X). On the left side, there is a small icon of a computer monitor. The main area of the dialog contains three labeled text input fields: "System:" with the text "STUDGA", "User ID:" with the text "ADMIN", and "Password:" which is currently empty. At the bottom of the dialog, there are two buttons: "OK" and "Cancel".

If necessary, confirm your User ID and Password. Then click the OK button to start the download.



The image shows a Windows-style dialog box titled "Client Access ODBC Driver Connect". It has a blue title bar with a question mark icon and a close button. Below the title bar is a tabbed interface with tabs labeled "Connection", "Server", "Format", "Performance", "Language", "Other", and "Other (2)". The "Connection" tab is currently selected. Inside the dialog, there are three input fields: "System:" with a dropdown menu showing "STUDGA", "User ID:" with a text box containing "Admin", and "Password:" with an empty text box. Below these fields is a checkbox labeled "Save changes if successful signon" which is currently unchecked. At the bottom of the dialog are four buttons: "OK", "Cancel", "Apply", and "Help".

Client Access ODBC Driver Connect

Connection | Server | Format | Performance | Language | Other | Other (2)

System:
STUDGA

User ID:
Admin

Password:

☐ Save changes if successful signon

OK Cancel Apply Help

Stage 2 Currency Conversion

Step 1 Enable Currency Conversion

To enable the Currency Conversion option, press the Currency Conversion button. 



Note: If this button is not displayed on the toolbar, Currency Conversion has not been enabled in System Configuration, contact your System Administrator.

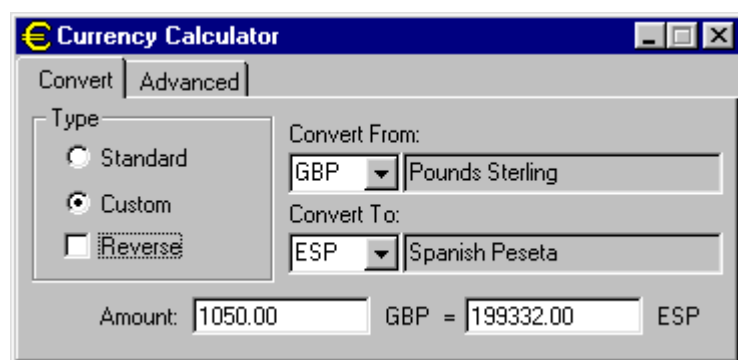
Step 2 Setting Up The Standard Conversion

Highlight a value field on any System 21 Application Window. Press the Ctrl+F1 key combination.



Note: If this is the first time you have used the currency conversion, the tooltip displays with no values in.

Switch to the minimised Currency Calculator Window.



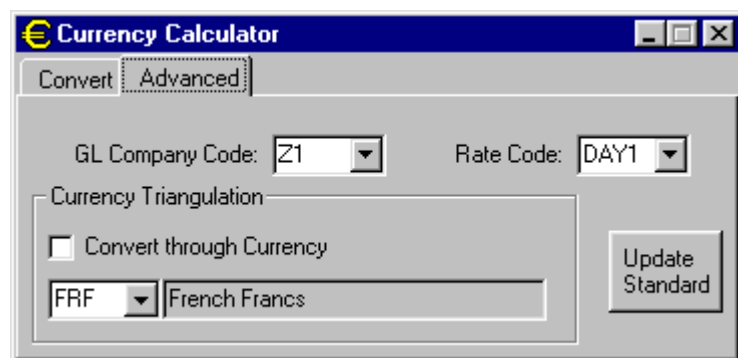
Set the Type to Custom.

Select the Convert From and Convert To currencies.



Note: If no currencies are displayed in the drop down list, check the GL Company Code and Rate Code set up on the Currency Calculator Advanced Window.

Select the Advanced Panel to display the Currency Calculator Advanced Window.



Then click the Update Standard button.

Step 3 Using The Standard Currency Conversion

To use the currency converter, put the mouse pointer over the value, on any System 21 application window, you want to convert. Then press the Ctrl+F1 key combination.

The currency calculation is displayed in a tooltip. This calculation shows the original value and currency, the exchange rate (or rates, if triangulation is being used), and the final value and currency:

[9072.56 GBP x 194] / 22.6 = 77879.50 FRF

Step 4 Using A Custom Currency Conversion

To use the currency converter, put the mouse pointer over the value you want to convert. Then press the Ctrl+F1 key combination.

Switch to the minimised Currency Calculator Window.

Set the Type to Custom.

Select the Convert From and Convert To currencies.

You can enter any amount in the Amount field to calculate the conversion. You can also reverse the conversion using the reverse field. For example, if the standard conversion is from pounds sterling to French francs, if you check the reverse box, the conversion is from French francs to pounds sterling.

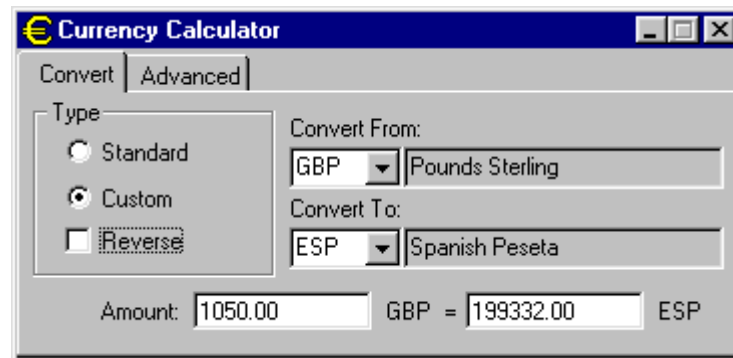
Currency Calculator Windows

The currency converter has one window, the Currency Calculator Window, with two different panels, Convert and Advanced.

Currency Calculator Convert Window



To display this window, put the mouse pointer over a value field on any System 21 application window, and press the Ctrl+F1 key combination. Then switch to the minimised Currency Calculator Window.



You can convert any entered amount from, or to, any currency specified in the currency file.

Fields:

Type

Choose between the standard conversion and a custom conversion.



Note: If you choose Standard, you cannot change the Convert From and Convert To currencies.

Reverse

Check the box to reverse the conversion. That is if the original conversion was from pounds to francs, to convert from francs to pounds.

Convert From

Select the original currency of the selected value.

Convert To

Select the new currency for the selected value.

Amount

Enter the amount you want to convert. This defaults to the value selected on the System 21 Application Window.

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This field displays the calculated value in the Convert To currency displayed.

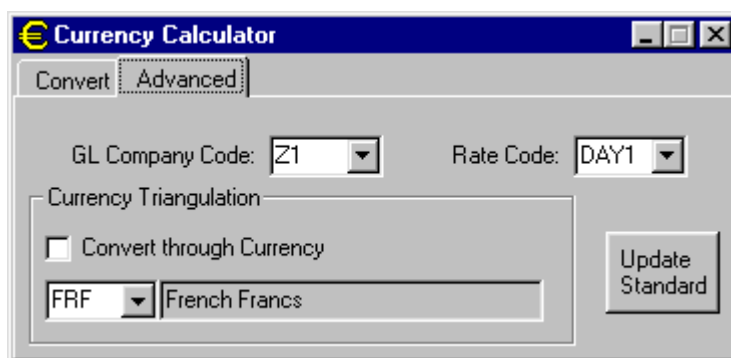


Note: This window has no buttons.

Currency Calculator Advanced Window



To display this window, put the mouse pointer over a value field on any System 21 Application window, and press the Ctrl+F1 key combination. Then switch to the minimised Currency Calculator Window and select the Advanced Panel.



You can specify which currency rates to use, and whether to use an intermediary currency to convert the currencies specified on the Currency Calculator Convert Window.

Fields and Buttons

GL Company Code

Select which General Ledger Company to use to find the exchange rates.

Rate Code

Select which Rate Code to use to find the exchange rates.

Currency Triangulation

Convert Through Currency

Check this box to use an intermediary currency to convert between the currencies selected on the Currency Calculator Convert Window.

If you check the box, select the currency to use as the intermediary.

Update Standard

Click this button to use the current details as the standard currency conversion.



Tip: The currencies used for the standard conversion are those selected on the Currency Calculator Convert Window when you click on this button.